

Drone-Enabled Occupations Evidence Guide



NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Keep the data label attached

All values are **May 2024 U.S. national medians** and **2024-2034 national projections** from BLS, accessed August 2026. They are not DFW starting pay or guarantees.

1. Three occupations

OCCUPATION	DRONE/DATA CONNECTION	TYPICAL PREPARATION	MEDIAN	GROWTH	OPENINGS/YEAR
Surveying and Mapping Technician	May use drones for site photos; processes mapping/GIS data	HS diploma typical; moderate-term OJT; some employers prefer GIS/technical education	\$51,940	5%	7,600
Cartographer / Photogrammetrist	Integrates imagery, LiDAR, GIS, CAD, and field data into maps	Bachelor's degree	\$78,380	6%	1,000
Aerospace Engineering and Operations Technologist / Technician	Runs, tests, records, and maintains equipment used to develop aircraft systems	Associate degree typical; some employers consider certificate/HS routes	\$79,830	8%	900

2. Published classroom rule

This is a course comparison rule, not an official government designation.

- **High wage:** national median is above the May 2024 all-occupations median of \$49,500.
- **High demand:** growth is above the 3% all-occupations projection; annual openings remain visible.
- **High skill:** preparation includes postsecondary education or moderate/long-term training and the work uses specialized technical duties.

One reason annual openings must stay visible:

3. Classify with evidence

SURVEYING AND MAPPING TECHNICIAN

High skill? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Preparation/duty evidence:

High wage? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Number and comparison:

High demand? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Growth and openings:

CARTOGRAPHER / PHOTOGRAMMETRIST

High skill? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Preparation/duty evidence:

High wage? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Number and comparison:

High demand? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Growth and openings:

AEROSPACE ENGINEERING AND OPERATIONS TECHNOLOGIST / TECHNICIAN

High skill? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Preparation/duty evidence:

High wage? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Number and comparison:

High demand? ☐ Yes ☐ No. Growth and openings:

4. Compare two occupations

Occupation A: _____ Occupation B: _____

Preparation difference:

Duty difference:

Labor-market difference:

5. Recommend a first investigation for fictional Taylor

Taylor likes fieldwork and technology but is not yet sure about a four-year degree.

First occupation to investigate: _____

Evidence that supports the recommendation:

Tradeoff or limitation Taylor should understand:

Current source or authorized person Taylor should use next:

Question to verify:

Sources

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Surveying and Mapping Technicians; Cartographers and Photogrammetrists; Aerospace Engineering and Operations Technologists and Technicians. Accessed August 2026.